VECTONIX TECHNOLOGIES

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DIGITAL MARKETING HANDBOOK

Strategy · Content · SEO · Social Media · Analytics

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CHAPTER 1

Introduction to Digital Marketing

The Modern Marketing Landscape

1.1 What is Digital Marketing?

Digital marketing is the promotion of products, services, and brands through digital channels such as search engines, social media, email, and websites. Unlike traditional marketing (print, TV, billboards), digital marketing is measurable, targeted, and cost-effective — making it accessible to businesses of all sizes.

STAT

Global digital ad spending reached $627 billion in 2023 and is expected to exceed $800 billion by 2026. India alone has 759 million internet users — the second largest internet population in the world.

1.2 Traditional vs Digital Marketing

Aspect	Traditional Marketing	Digital Marketing
Reach	Local/national print, TV, radio	Global — anyone with internet
Cost	High (lakhs for TV ads)	Low to moderate (scalable budget)
Targeting	Broad demographic	Precise: age, city, interest, behaviour
Measurement	Difficult (estimated impressions)	Exact: clicks, conversions, ROI
Interaction	One-way broadcast	Two-way (comments, shares, DMs)
Speed	Weeks to months to launch	Live in hours
Examples	Newspaper ads, TV commercials	Google Ads, Instagram posts, email

1.3 The Digital Marketing Ecosystem

Channel	What It Is	Best For
SEO	Organic search engine ranking	Long-term traffic, credibility
SEM / PPC	Paid search ads (Google Ads)	Immediate traffic, e-commerce
Social Media	Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, Twitter	Brand awareness, engagement
Content Marketing	Blogs, videos, infographics	Education, trust building
Email Marketing	Newsletters, automated sequences	Retention, conversions
Influencer Marketing	Partnering with creators	Reach niche audiences
Affiliate Marketing	Commission-based promotion	Performance-driven sales

1.4 Key Metrics Every Marketer Must Know

Metric	Full Name	What It Tells You	Formula
CTR	Click-Through Rate	How compelling your ad/link is	(Clicks / Impressions) x 100
CPC	Cost Per Click	How much you pay per click	Total Ad Spend / Total Clicks
CPM	Cost Per Mille	Cost per 1000 impressions	(Total Spend / Impressions) x 1000
CVR	Conversion Rate	% visitors who take action	(Conversions / Visitors) x 100
ROAS	Return on Ad Spend	Revenue earned per rupee spent	Revenue / Ad Spend
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost	Cost to acquire one customer	Total Spend / New Customers
LTV	Lifetime Value	Revenue from a customer over time	Avg purchase x frequency x duration

Chapter 1 — Exercises

Part A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. What is a key advantage of digital marketing over traditional marketing?

- A) It is always cheaper
- B) It is measurable and precisely targeted
- C) It only works online
- D) It requires no content

2. What does CTR stand for?

- A) Content Transfer Rate
- B) Click-Through Rate
- C) Cost Tracking Ratio
- D) Campaign Traffic Report

3. Which channel is best for building long-term organic traffic?

- A) Paid Ads
- B) Email Marketing
- C) SEO
- D) Influencer Marketing

4. What does CPM measure?

- A) Cost per message
- B) Cost per 1000 impressions
- C) Clicks per month
- D) Cost per minute

5. ROAS of 4 means:

- A) 4 clicks per rupee
- B) Rs. 4 earned for every rupee spent on ads
- C) 4% conversion rate
- D) 4 new customers per campaign

Part B: Short Answer Questions

1. Explain the difference between SEO and SEM. When would a business use each?

2. A company spends Rs. 10,000 on ads and gets 500 clicks and 20 conversions. Calculate CTR, CPC, and conversion rate.

3. Why is digital marketing particularly advantageous for small businesses and startups?

4. What is LTV and why is it an important metric for subscription businesses?

5. List three digital marketing channels and explain which type of business would benefit most from each.

Part C: Practical Exercises

Exercise 1: Choose a local business (a restaurant, salon, or shop near you). Research their current digital presence: Do they have a website? Social media? Google My Business? Write a one-page audit noting what they do well and what's missing.

Exercise 2: Calculate digital marketing metrics: A campaign spent Rs. 25,000, received 5,000 impressions, 250 clicks, and 15 purchases worth Rs. 2,000 each. Calculate CTR, CPC, CVR, and ROAS.

Part D: Scenario

You are advising a homemade pickle business run by a woman who makes 200 jars per month. She currently sells to neighbours but wants to grow online. She has a budget of Rs. 3,000 per month for marketing. Which digital marketing channels would you recommend and why? Outline a 3-month plan.

Answer Key

• MCQ: 1-B, 2-B, 3-C, 4-B, 5-B

• Short 1: SEO=free organic ranking, takes months; SEM=paid ads, immediate results. New business uses SEM for quick traffic, invests in SEO for long term.

• Short 2: CTR = 250/500 impressions... wait — 500 clicks/impressions not given. CPC = 10,000/500 = Rs. 20. CVR = 20/500 x 100 = 4%.

• Short 3: Low cost to start; precise targeting of local audience; measurable results; scalable budget.

• Short 4: LTV = revenue from one customer over lifetime; subscription businesses depend on renewals; higher LTV justifies higher CAC.

• Short 5: SEO=content businesses (blogs, tutorials); Social Media=B2C brands, restaurants; Email=e-commerce with repeat buyers.

CHAPTER 2

Social Media Marketing

Building Communities and Driving Engagement

2.1 The Major Platforms at a Glance

Platform	Users (India)	Primary Audience	Best Content Type	Ad Formats
Instagram	230M+	18-34, lifestyle	Photos, Reels, Stories	Feed ads, Story ads, Reels ads
YouTube	450M+	All ages	Videos, Shorts	Pre-roll, mid-roll, bumper
Facebook	280M+	25-45, diverse	Posts, videos, groups	Feed, Messenger, carousel
LinkedIn	100M+	Professionals, B2B	Articles, posts, jobs	Sponsored posts, InMail
Twitter/X	25M+	News, tech, politics	Text threads, news	Promoted tweets
WhatsApp	500M+	All demographics	Messages, broadcasts	WhatsApp Business API

2.2 The Content Mix — 70-20-10 Rule

A successful social media content strategy balances three types of content:

Type	Percentage	Description	Example
Value/Educational	70%	Content that helps your audience	Tips, tutorials, how-tos, infographics
Curated/Shared	20%	Content from others your audience will like	Industry news, reposts, collaborations
Promotional	10%	Direct sales and product pushes	Discount offers, product launches

TIP

Posting too much promotional content drives away followers. The 70-20-10 rule keeps your audience engaged without feeling constantly sold to.

2.3 Instagram Strategy — A Practical Framework

Content Pillars

Choose 3-5 core topics your brand talks about consistently. Example for a fitness brand:

- Workout Tips (Education)
- Transformation Stories (Social proof)
- Nutrition Advice (Value)
- Behind the Scenes (Authenticity)
- Product Features (Promotional)

Posting Schedule

Format	Frequency	Best Time (India)	Why
Feed Posts	4-5x per week	7-9am, 12-2pm, 7-9pm	Morning commute + lunch + evening
Reels	3-4x per week	Tue-Fri evenings	Highest algorithm boost currently
Stories	Daily	Throughout the day	Keeps top-of-mind
Live	1-2x per month	Weekends 7-9pm	Higher engagement window

2.4 Writing Captions That Convert

Element	Description	Example
Hook	First line must stop the scroll	Stop scrolling if you want to lose weight without gym
Value	Deliver what the hook promised	3 home exercises, 10 min each, zero equipment...
Social Proof	Build trust	Helped 500+ people in the last 6 months
CTA	Tell them what to do next	Save this post + tag a friend who needs this
Hashtags	Reach + discoverability	3-5 large + 5-8 medium + 3-5 niche hashtags

Chapter 2 — Exercises

Part A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. What does the 70-20-10 content rule mean?

- A) 70% ads, 20% content, 10% engagement
- B) 70% value, 20% curated, 10% promotional
- C) 70% visuals, 20% text, 10% links
- D) 70% Instagram, 20% Facebook, 10% Twitter

2. Which metric measures how often people interact with your content?

- A) Reach
- B) Impressions
- C) Engagement Rate
- D) Conversion Rate

3. What is a content pillar?

- A) A scheduled post
- B) A core topic your brand consistently creates content about
- C) A paid ad campaign
- D) A type of hashtag

4. Which platform is best for professional B2B marketing in India?

- A) Instagram
- B) Snapchat
- C) LinkedIn
- D) Pinterest

5. What is the first element of a caption that stops people from scrolling?

- A) Hashtags
- B) Call-to-action
- C) Social proof
- D) The Hook

Part B: Short Answer Questions

1. Explain the difference between organic reach and paid reach on social media.

2. What is a social media content calendar and why is it important?

3. How would you measure the success of a social media campaign?

4. What is engagement rate and how is it calculated?

5. Name three types of Instagram content and explain when to use each.

Part C: Practical Exercises

Exercise 1: Choose a real brand you like (on Instagram or LinkedIn). Analyse their last 10 posts: What content pillars do they use? How often do they post? What is their average engagement? Write a 200-word analysis.

Exercise 2: Create a 1-week social media content calendar for a fictional chai brand targeting college students. Include post type, caption idea, hashtag strategy, and best posting time for each day.

Part D: Scenario

A new local bakery in your city wants to grow on Instagram from 0 followers to 1,000 in 60 days with zero paid budget. Outline a complete organic Instagram strategy: profile setup, content pillars, posting schedule, hashtag strategy, and three engagement tactics.

Answer Key

• MCQ: 1-B, 2-C, 3-B, 4-C, 5-D

• Short 1: Organic=people see your content naturally through the algorithm; Paid=you pay to boost reach beyond your followers.

• Short 2: A calendar plans what content to post, when, and on which platform; prevents last-minute posts, ensures consistency.

• Short 3: Track KPIs: reach, engagement rate, follower growth, website clicks, conversions, hashtag performance.

• Short 4: (Likes+Comments+Shares) / Followers x 100; measures how relevant your content is to your audience.

• Short 5: Feed Posts (permanent, high-quality); Stories (daily, casual, polls/questions); Reels (viral, educational, entertaining).

CHAPTER 3

Content Marketing

Create, Distribute, and Convert with Content

STAT

Content marketing generates 3x more leads than paid advertising at 62% less cost. Companies that blog receive 97% more inbound links to their website. (HubSpot Research)

3.1 The Content Marketing Funnel

Funnel Stage	Customer Mindset	Best Content Types	Goal
TOFU (Top)	Awareness — I have a problem	Blog posts, infographics, videos, social posts	Get discovered
MOFU (Middle)	Consideration — I'm researching solutions	Guides, webinars, case studies, comparison posts	Build trust
BOFU (Bottom)	Decision — I'm ready to buy	Demos, free trials, testimonials, discounts	Convert to customer
Retention	Post-purchase — Did I choose right?	Tutorials, newsletters, community	Retain and upsell

3.2 Blog Writing for Digital Marketing

Blog Post Structure

Headline: Use numbers, questions, or power words. '7 Ways to...' or 'Why Your Instagram Isn't Growing'

Introduction: State the problem, promise the solution, give a reason to read on.

Subheadings (H2/H3): Break the post into scannable sections. Most readers scan before they read.

Body: Mix short paragraphs, bullets, images, and examples. No wall of text.

CTA: Every post needs one: subscribe, share, download, comment.

SEO Optimization: Include target keyword in title, first paragraph, a subheading, and meta description.

3.3 Video Content Strategy

Video Type	Length	Platform	Use Case
Short-form Reels	15-60 sec	Instagram, YouTube Shorts	Viral, entertainment, quick tips
Explainer Video	2-5 min	YouTube, Website	Product demos, how-tos
Webinar	45-90 min	YouTube Live, Zoom	Education, lead generation
Testimonial	1-3 min	Website, LinkedIn	Social proof
Behind the Scenes	1-5 min	Instagram Stories, YouTube	Authenticity, brand personality

3.4 Content Calendar Template

Weekly Content Planner

Week of: _____

Monday — Blog Post Title: _____

Tuesday — Instagram Post Idea: _____

Wednesday — LinkedIn Post Idea: _____

Thursday — YouTube/Reels Idea: _____

Friday — Newsletter Topic: _____

Weekend — Engagement Activity: _____

Core Keyword Focus This Week: _____

CTA / Offer Being Promoted: _____

Chapter 3 — Exercises

Part A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. What is TOFU in content marketing?

- A) A healthy food product
- B) Top of Funnel — awareness stage content
- C) Type of Facebook Update
- D) Target Outcome Framework Update

2. Which type of content is best for the decision stage of the funnel?

- A) Blog posts
- B) Infographics
- C) Customer testimonials and demos
- D) Social media posts

3. What should every blog post include?

- A) Only images
- B) A clear call-to-action
- C) Minimum 3,000 words
- D) Paid backlinks

4. What is evergreen content?

- A) Content about nature
- B) Seasonal promotional content
- C) Content that stays relevant and drives traffic for years
- D) Green-themed branding

5. Which content type typically generates the highest engagement on social media?

- A) Text-only posts
- B) Stock photo posts
- C) Short videos and Reels
- D) Long articles

Part B: Short Answer Questions

1. Explain the content marketing funnel with one example of content for each stage.

2. What makes a blog headline effective? Write two examples of strong headlines.

3. What is the difference between evergreen content and trending content?

4. How do you repurpose a single blog post into multiple content formats?

5. Why is consistency more important than frequency in content marketing?

Part C: Practical Exercises

Exercise 1: Write a complete blog post outline (not the full post) for the topic: '5 Free Digital Marketing Tools Every Beginner Should Use'. Include: headline, introduction hook, 5 subheadings with 2-3 bullet points each, and a CTA.

Exercise 2: Create a repurposing plan for this blog post: How would you turn it into an Instagram carousel, a LinkedIn post, a 60-second Reel script, and an email newsletter?

Part D: Scenario

A startup selling organic skincare products wants to build a content marketing strategy from scratch. They have a website but no blog and minimal social media presence. They can invest 10 hours per week on content. Recommend a content strategy: what to create, which platforms, posting frequency, and how to measure success.

Answer Key

• MCQ: 1-B, 2-C, 3-B, 4-C, 5-C

• Short 1: TOFU=blog post about 'what is digital marketing'; MOFU=guide comparing top tools; BOFU=demo + testimonial.

• Short 2: Use numbers (7 Ways), emotions, clear promise. E.g., '5 Mistakes Killing Your Instagram Growth' or 'How I Got 10,000 Followers in 30 Days'.

• Short 3: Evergreen=always relevant (how to start a blog); Trending=timely (IPL marketing tips 2026).

• Short 4: Blog post → LinkedIn article → 10 Instagram posts → YouTube explainer → email newsletter → 5 Twitter threads.

• Short 5: Audience builds habit; algorithm rewards regular creators; inconsistency breaks trust. Better to post 3x/week always than 7x/week for a month then stop.

CHAPTER 4

Search Engine Optimisation

Rank Higher, Get Found, Drive Free Traffic

4.1 How Search Engines Work

Search engines like Google follow three steps: Crawl → Index → Rank. Understanding this helps you optimise your site for each step.

Step	What Happens	Your Job
Crawl	Googlebot visits your pages following links	Make sure pages are accessible (no noindex, no 403)
Index	Page content is stored in Google's database	Create clear, well-structured content to be indexed
Rank	Pages are sorted by 200+ ranking factors	Optimise for relevance, authority, and user experience

4.2 On-Page SEO Checklist

Element	Best Practice	Example
Title Tag	50-60 chars; include primary keyword near start	Digital Marketing Tips for Beginners | Vectonix
Meta Description	150-160 chars; compelling; include keyword	Learn 10 proven digital marketing strategies for startups in 2026.
H1 Tag	One per page; matches search intent	10 Proven Digital Marketing Strategies (2026)
URL Slug	Short, descriptive, hyphens not underscores	vectonix.in/blog/digital-marketing-strategies
Image Alt Text	Describes the image; includes keyword if relevant	digital-marketing-funnel-diagram
Internal Links	Link to related pages on your site	Link blog post to your service page
Page Speed	Under 3 seconds; mobile friendly	Use Google PageSpeed Insights to test
Keyword Density	1-2% naturally throughout content	Don't stuff; write naturally

4.3 Keyword Research — Step by Step

Step 1: Seed Keywords — Start with basic terms: 'digital marketing', 'social media tips'

Step 2: Use Free Tools — Google Keyword Planner, Ubersuggest, Answer the Public, Google autocomplete

Step 3: Analyse Metrics — Search Volume (how many searches/month) + Keyword Difficulty (0-100; lower = easier to rank)

Step 4: Classify Intent — Informational (how to...) / Navigational (brand name) / Transactional (buy, price, near me)

Step 5: Choose Targets — Beginners: low difficulty (under 30), decent volume (500-5,000/month)

Step 6: Map to Content — One primary keyword + 3-5 related keywords per page

4.4 Link Building (Off-Page SEO)

Tactic	Description	Difficulty	Impact
Guest Blogging	Write posts for other websites in exchange for a backlink	Medium	High
Broken Link Building	Find broken links on sites and offer your content as replacement	Medium	High
Resource Page Outreach	Get listed on 'best resources' pages in your niche	Medium	High
Create Linkable Assets	Infographics, original research, free tools attract links naturally	Hard	Very High
Social Sharing	Sharing content increases visibility which can lead to links	Easy	Low-Medium

Chapter 4 — Exercises

Part A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. What are the three steps search engines follow?

- A) Search, Find, Display
- B) Crawl, Index, Rank
- C) Read, Store, Sort
- D) Scan, Cache, List

2. What is the ideal length for a meta description?

- A) 50-60 characters
- B) 300-400 characters
- C) 150-160 characters
- D) As long as possible

3. What is keyword difficulty in SEO tools?

- A) How hard it is to spell the keyword
- B) How competitive it is to rank for a keyword
- C) How many times you should use the keyword
- D) The length of the keyword

4. What is a backlink?

- A) A link inside your own website
- B) A link from another website pointing to yours
- C) A broken link
- D) An image link

5. Which type of keyword intent shows the user wants to buy something?

- A) Informational
- B) Navigational
- C) Transactional
- D) Inspirational

Part B: Short Answer Questions

1. What is the difference between on-page SEO and off-page SEO?

2. Why is page loading speed important for SEO?

3. What is keyword search intent and why does it matter for content creation?

4. Explain the difference between 'white hat' and 'black hat' SEO techniques.

5. What is a sitemap and why is it important?

Part C: Practical Exercises

Exercise 1: Choose a topic you know well. Use Google Keyword Planner or Ubersuggest to find: 1 high-volume keyword, 1 long-tail keyword, 1 question keyword. Note their search volume and difficulty score.

Exercise 2: Perform an on-page SEO audit on any blog post or webpage: check title tag, meta description, H1, URL, images, and loading speed. List 3 improvements with specific recommendations.

Part D: Scenario

A fashion blogger has been writing for 2 years but barely gets 100 visitors per month from Google. She writes about sustainable fashion. Diagnose what might be wrong and provide a complete SEO improvement plan covering keyword strategy, on-page fixes, and link building tactics she can start this week.

Answer Key

• MCQ: 1-B, 2-C, 3-B, 4-B, 5-C

• Short 1: On-page=elements on your website (title, content, speed); Off-page=external factors (backlinks, social signals).

• Short 2: Slow pages rank lower; Google considers Core Web Vitals; users abandon pages that take over 3 seconds.

• Short 3: Intent = what user actually wants; informational wants to learn; transactional wants to buy; wrong intent = high bounce rate.

• Short 4: White hat=ethical (quality content, natural links); Black hat=manipulative (keyword stuffing, bought links) and can get penalised.

• Short 5: XML file listing all pages; helps Googlebot discover and crawl all your content; especially important for new sites.

CHAPTER 5

Campaign Management & Email Marketing

Run Campaigns That Convert

5.1 Digital Campaign Planning — The SOSTAC Framework

SOSTAC Letter	Stands For	Key Question	Example
S	Situation	Where are we now?	Market analysis, competitor audit, current metrics
O	Objectives	Where do we want to be?	Grow followers by 30% in 90 days
S	Strategy	How do we get there?	Focus on Reels + SEO blog content
T	Tactics	What exactly will we do?	Post 4 Reels/week, publish 2 blogs/week
A	Actions	Who does what by when?	Rohan creates Reels, Priya writes blogs
C	Control	How do we measure success?	Review analytics every Monday

5.2 Running a Google Ads Campaign — Step by Step

Step 1: Define Goal — Increase website visits, phone calls, or purchases

Step 2: Choose Campaign Type — Search (text ads), Display (banner), Shopping (products), Video (YouTube)

Step 3: Set Budget — Daily budget: how much to spend per day maximum. Start with Rs. 200-500/day to test.

Step 4: Keyword Research — Use Google Keyword Planner. Match types: Broad / Phrase / Exact

Step 5: Write Ad Copy — Headline 1 + Headline 2 + Headline 3 + Description 1 + Description 2. Include keyword.

Step 6: Set Bidding Strategy — Manual CPC (control) or Maximize Conversions (automated, needs data)

Step 7: Landing Page — Ad should link to a specific page matching the ad. Not just the homepage.

Step 8: Monitor and Optimise — Check daily: CTR, Quality Score, Conversion Rate. Pause bad keywords.

5.3 Email Marketing — The Highest ROI Channel

> **STAT**

> Email marketing delivers an average ROI of Rs. 3,600 for every Rs. 100 spent — the highest of any digital channel. For every Rs. 1 spent, email returns Rs. 36 on average. (Litmus, 2024)

Email Type	When to Send	Subject Line Strategy	CTA
Welcome Email	Immediately on signup	Welcome to Vectonix! Here's your gift...	Watch the intro video
Newsletter	Weekly or fortnightly	5 things I learned this week + free template	Read the full post
Promotional	Before sale/event	LAST CHANCE: 40% off ends tonight	Shop Now
Re-engagement	After 90+ days of inactivity	We miss you — here's 20% off	Come back
Abandoned Cart	1 hour after cart abandonment	Did you forget something?	Complete your order

5.4 A/B Testing in Campaigns

A/B testing (split testing) shows two versions of an ad/email to different groups to find which performs better.

What to Test	Version A	Version B	Metric to Watch
Email subject	20% OFF — Today Only	Your exclusive offer inside	Open Rate
Ad headline	Buy Organic Tea Online	Tea That Tastes Like Home	CTR
CTA button	Buy Now	Get My Order	Conversion Rate
Landing page image	Product photo	Lifestyle photo	Bounce Rate, CVR

Chapter 5 — Exercises

Part A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. What does SOSTAC stand for?

- A) Strategy, Objectives, Sales, Tactics, Analytics, Control
- B) Situation, Objectives, Strategy, Tactics, Actions, Control
- C) Search, Organic, Social, Traffic, Ads, Conversions
- D) Scale, Optimise, Segment, Test, Automate, Convert

2. What is A/B testing?

- A) Testing two different websites
- B) Comparing two versions of an ad or email to find the better one
- C) Auditing your competitor's ads
- D) Testing ad campaigns on two platforms

3. Which type of Google Ads campaign shows text ads in search results?

- A) Display Campaign
- B) Shopping Campaign
- C) Search Campaign
- D) Video Campaign

4. What is the recommended first step before writing ad copy?

- A) Set the budget
- B) Define the goal
- C) Write the landing page
- D) Pick the ad format

5. What email type is sent when someone leaves items in their shopping cart?

- A) Welcome email
- B) Newsletter
- C) Re-engagement email
- D) Abandoned cart email

Part B: Short Answer Questions

1. What is Quality Score in Google Ads and why does it matter?

2. Explain the SOSTAC framework in your own words using a real example.

3. What makes a good email subject line?

4. What is segmentation in email marketing and why is it important?

5. What is the difference between a 'hard bounce' and a 'soft bounce' in email?

Part C: Practical Exercises

Exercise 1: Write two versions of a Google Search ad for a digital marketing course. Version A: feature-focused. Version B: benefit-focused. Include 3 headlines and 2 descriptions for each.

Exercise 2: Create an email marketing sequence for a new online course launch: write subject lines and a one-sentence description for a 5-email sequence (Day 0 welcome, Day 2 value, Day 5 social proof, Day 7 urgency, Day 8 last chance).

Part D: Scenario

A small yoga studio wants to run their first digital campaign to get 20 new class bookings in 30 days. They have Rs. 8,000 budget. Using the SOSTAC framework, plan their complete campaign: objectives, strategy, which channel(s) to use, ad copy direction, and how they'll measure success.

Answer Key

• MCQ: 1-B, 2-B, 3-C, 4-B, 5-D

• Short 1: Quality Score (1-10) = relevance of keyword+ad+landing page; higher score = lower CPC and better ad position.

• Short 2: S=We have 200 IG followers; O=Get to 1,000 in 60 days; S=Organic Reels focus; T=4 Reels/week; A=Priya films on Monday, edits Tuesday; C=Review Sunday.

• Short 3: Under 50 chars; creates curiosity or urgency; personalized if possible; avoids spam words (FREE!!! ALL CAPS).

• Short 4: Dividing list by interest/behaviour/demographics to send more relevant emails; segmented emails get 58% higher open rates.

• Short 5: Hard bounce=email address doesn't exist (permanent); Soft bounce=inbox full or server issue (temporary). Hard bounces must be removed.

CHAPTER 6

Google Analytics & Marketing Tools

Measure Everything, Improve Continuously

6.1 Google Analytics 4 (GA4) — Key Reports

Report	Where to Find	What It Shows	Use It To
Users & Sessions	Reports > Acquisition	Total visitors, new vs returning	Track overall growth
Traffic Sources	Reports > Acquisition > Traffic	Where visitors come from (organic, social, direct)	Know which channel drives most traffic
Engagement	Reports > Engagement	Pages visited, time on site, scroll depth	Identify your best content
Conversions	Reports > Engagement > Conversions	Goal completions (form fills, purchases)	Measure ROI
Demographics	Reports > User > User attributes	Age, gender, location of visitors	Validate your target audience
Real-time	Reports > Realtime	Who is on your site right now	Monitor campaigns as they launch

6.2 Essential Free Marketing Tools

Tool	What It Does	Free Tier Limit
Google Analytics 4	Website traffic and user behavior	Free, unlimited
Google Search Console	Keyword rankings, clicks from Google	Free, unlimited
Google Keyword Planner	Keyword research and search volume	Free with Google Ads account
Canva	Social media graphics and design	Free tier with templates
Mailchimp	Email marketing and automation	Free up to 500 subscribers
Buffer / Later	Social media scheduling	Free for 1-3 accounts
Ubersuggest	SEO and keyword research	Free 3 searches/day
SEMrush / Ahrefs	Full SEO suite, competitor research	Limited free tier
ChatGPT	Content ideas, copywriting assistance	Free tier available
Hotjar	Heatmaps — see where users click	Free up to 35 sessions/day

6.3 Building a Marketing Dashboard

A marketing dashboard centralises your key metrics in one place so you can see performance at a glance. Here is what to include:

Category	Metric	Target	Source
Website	Total Sessions	1000/month	Google Analytics
Website	Bounce Rate	Under 50%	Google Analytics
SEO	Organic Search Traffic	500/month	Google Search Console
SEO	Number of Ranking Keywords	50+	Search Console
Social Media	Follower Growth Rate	5%/month	Native app
Social Media	Avg Engagement Rate	3-6%	Native app
Email	Open Rate	25%+	Email platform
Email	Click Rate	3%+	Email platform
Paid Ads	ROAS	4x+	Google Ads / Meta Ads
Conversions	Conversion Rate	2%+	Google Analytics

Chapter 6 — Exercises

Part A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. What does Google Search Console primarily show?

- A) Social media metrics
- B) Email campaign performance
- C) How your website performs in Google Search
- D) Website design quality

2. What is a bounce rate?

- A) The rate of ad clicks
- B) Percentage of visitors who leave after viewing just one page
- C) Email unsubscribe rate
- D) Social media unfollow rate

3. What does GA4 stand for?

- A) Google App 4
- B) Google Alerts 4
- C) Google Analytics 4
- D) Google Advertising 4th Edition

4. What is a UTM parameter?

- A) A type of SEO tag
- B) A tracking code added to URLs to track campaign sources
- C) A social media metric
- D) A website speed test

5. What does a heatmap tool like Hotjar show?

- A) Your website's temperature
- B) Where users click and scroll on your pages
- C) Server load data
- D) Email open locations

Part B: Short Answer Questions

1. What is the difference between sessions and users in Google Analytics?

2. How would you use UTM parameters to track a specific email campaign?

3. What metrics would you check to evaluate a blog post's performance?

4. Why is setting conversion goals in GA4 important?

5. What is a KPI and how is it different from a vanity metric?

Part C: Practical Exercises

Exercise 1: Set up a free Google Analytics 4 account for a test website (or use the Google Analytics Demo Account). Navigate to 3 different reports and document what data you find and what insights you can draw.

Exercise 2: Create a simple marketing performance spreadsheet that tracks: weekly website visits, top 3 traffic sources, social media follower count, email list size, and top performing content. Fill in hypothetical data for 4 weeks.

Part D: Scenario

You are the digital marketing intern at a startup. After 2 months of running campaigns, you need to present results to the founder. Using the metrics and tools covered in this chapter, explain what you would include in your report, how you would present good and bad results, and what your recommendations would be for the next month.

Answer Key

• MCQ: 1-C, 2-B, 3-C, 4-B, 5-B

• Short 1: Users=unique individuals; Sessions=total visits (one user can have multiple sessions). Sessions always >= Users.

• Short 2: Add ?utm_source=email&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=may_launch to your links.

• Short 3: Page views, average time on page, bounce rate, scroll depth, backlinks gained, keyword rankings.

• Short 4: Without goals, GA4 only shows traffic; goals show whether traffic is converting to business outcomes.

• Short 5: KPI=metric tied to business goal (conversions, revenue); Vanity metric=looks good but doesn't drive decisions (likes, impressions).

CHAPTER 7

Digital Marketing Strategy

Bringing It All Together

7.1 The Buyer Persona

A buyer persona is a detailed, semi-fictional profile of your ideal customer. All marketing decisions should be based on what this person needs, wants, fears, and values.

Buyer Persona Template

Name (fictional): _____

Age & Location: _____

Job Title & Income: _____

Goals (What do they want to achieve?): _____

Challenges (What problems do they face?): _____

Social Media Platforms Used: _____

Preferred Content Type (video/blog/podcast): _____

Buying Triggers (What makes them buy?): _____

Objections (Why might they not buy?): _____

Brands They Love: _____

7.2 The 4-Week Digital Marketing Sprint

Week	Focus	Key Activities	Deliverable
1	Research & Setup	Audience research, competitor analysis, platform setup, analytics	Strategy doc, personas, content calendar
2	Content Creation	Write blogs, create social content, design graphics, record videos	Content bank (4 weeks of posts)
3	Launch & Distribute	Publish content, run ads, send emails, engage with comments	Live campaigns, published content

4	Review & Optimise	Analyse all metrics, A/B test results, adjust strategy	Performance report, optimised campaigns

7.3 Competitor Analysis Framework

Competitor	Their Strengths	Their Weaknesses	Opportunity for You
Competitor A	_____	_____	_____
Competitor B	_____	_____	_____
Competitor C	_____	_____	_____

7.4 Digital Marketing Ethics

• Data Privacy: Always comply with data protection laws (India's DPDP Act 2023). Don't collect data you don't need.

• Transparency: Clearly label paid promotions and ads. Influencers must disclose sponsorships.

• Honest Advertising: No misleading claims. False advertising is illegal and damages brand trust.

• Respect & Inclusion: Avoid stereotypes. Represent your audience authentically.

• Sustainable Practices: Don't contribute to misinformation. Fact-check before sharing.

Chapter 7 — Exercises

Part A: Multiple Choice Questions

1. What is a buyer persona?

- A) A type of advertisement
- B) A detailed profile of your ideal customer
- C) A social media platform
- D) An analytics report

2. What is the purpose of a competitor analysis?

- A) To copy competitors exactly
- B) To find gaps and opportunities in the market
- C) To report competitors to authorities
- D) To create negative advertising

3. What does the DPDP Act 2023 relate to?

- A) Digital advertising standards
- B) Personal data protection in India
- C) Domain name registrations
- D) Digital copyright law

4. What is the first week of the 4-week sprint focused on?

- A) Launching ads
- B) Writing blog posts
- C) Research and setup
- D) Reviewing results

5. What should a digital marketing strategy always start with?

- A) Creating ads
- B) Buying followers
- C) Understanding your audience and goals
- D) Posting on all platforms

Part B: Short Answer Questions

1. Why is creating a buyer persona important before launching any campaign?

2. What is SWOT analysis and how is it used in digital marketing strategy?

3. Explain the difference between a digital marketing strategy and a digital marketing tactic.

4. Why is competitor analysis important in digital marketing?

5. What is the Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 and what does it mean for marketers?

Part C: Practical Exercises

Exercise 1: Create a buyer persona for a fictional online coding course targeting college students aged 18-22 in tier 2 cities in India. Include: demographics, goals, challenges, platforms used, buying triggers, and objections.

Exercise 2: Perform a competitor analysis for two brands in the same niche you choose. Compare their: social media presence, content strategy, SEO ranking for one keyword, and what they do better or worse than each other.

Part D: Scenario

You are the digital marketing lead at Vectonix Technologies. The company wants to launch a paid online course on digital marketing for students. You have 45 days and Rs. 50,000 budget for marketing. Create a complete go-to-market strategy using concepts from all 7 chapters: define your audience, choose channels, plan content, set up campaigns, and define success metrics.

Answer Key

• MCQ: 1-B, 2-B, 3-B, 4-C, 5-C

• Short 1: All content, messaging, and channel choices should serve one specific audience; without it you create for everyone = for no one.

• Short 2: Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats; in DM: audit current channel performance, identify growth opportunities, spot competitor gaps.

• Short 3: Strategy=long-term plan (grow organic traffic); Tactic=specific action (publish 2 SEO blogs per week this month).

• Short 4: Reveals what content works in your industry; shows gaps you can fill; helps you differentiate your positioning.

• Short 5: India's data privacy law requiring explicit consent for collecting data; marketers must state what data is collected and why; opt-in required.

CHAPTER T

Templates & Frameworks

Ready-to-Use Marketing Tools

Template 1: Social Media Content Calendar

Monthly Content Calendar

Month: _____

Brand / Client: _____

Primary Goal: _____

Week 1 Theme: _____

Week 1 Content (Mon-Sun): _____

Week 2 Theme: _____

Week 2 Content (Mon-Sun): _____

Week 3 Theme: _____

Week 3 Content (Mon-Sun): _____

Week 4 Theme: _____

Week 4 Content (Mon-Sun): _____

Monthly KPIs to Track: _____

Template 2: Campaign Brief

Campaign Brief

Campaign Name: _____

Brand / Product: _____

Campaign Goal (SMART): _____

Target Audience (Persona): _____

Budget (Total / Per Channel): _____

Timeline (Start – End Date): _____

Key Message (One sentence): _____

Channels Used: _____

Ad Formats: _____

Landing Page URL: _____

Success Metrics (KPIs): _____

Approval Required From: _____

Template 3: Blog Post SEO Checklist

Pre-Publish SEO Checklist

Article Title (include primary keyword): _____

Meta Description (150-160 chars, includes keyword): _____

H1 contains keyword: Yes / No: _____

Keyword in first 100 words: Yes / No: _____

Number of internal links added: _____

Number of external links to authority sites: _____

All images have alt text: Yes / No: _____

Page loading speed tested: Yes / No (Score: ___): _____

Mobile-friendly tested: Yes / No: _____

Social share image created: Yes / No: _____

Template 4: Email Marketing Checklist

Pre-Send Email Checklist

Subject line written and A/B version created: _____

Preview text optimised (first 40 chars): _____

Personalisation token tested (First Name, etc.): _____

All links tested and working: _____

Images have alt text: _____

Unsubscribe link present: Yes / No: _____

Sent test email to self: Yes / No: _____

Correct list segment selected: _____

Send time scheduled for optimal open rate: _____

Tracking UTMs added to all links: _____

Template 5: Monthly Marketing Report

Monthly Performance Report

Report Month: _____

Prepared By: _____

Date: _____

Executive Summary (3 bullet points): _____

Website: Sessions / Users / Top Source / Bounce Rate:

_____

SEO: Organic Traffic / New Keywords Ranked: _____

Social Media: Followers Gained / Best Post / Avg Engagement Rate:

_____

Email: Open Rate / Click Rate / Unsubscribes: _____

Paid Ads: Spend / Clicks / Conversions / ROAS: _____

Top 3 Wins This Month: _____

Top 3 Challenges This Month: _____

Recommendations for Next Month: _____

CHAPTER P

Practical Projects

Real-World Digital Marketing Campaigns

Project 1: Brand Audit

Choose a local business (restaurant, shop, startup, NGO). Perform a complete digital marketing audit.

- Website Analysis: SEO, speed, mobile friendliness, CTA clarity
- Social Media Audit: which platforms, posting frequency, content quality, engagement rate
- Search Presence: Google Business Profile, reviews, search ranking for 3 keywords
- Email: Do they have a newsletter? Test their sign-up flow.
- Competitor Comparison: compare with 2 competitors on the above dimensions
- Recommendations: 5 specific, actionable improvements prioritised by impact

Project 2: Social Media Campaign

Create and execute (or fully plan) a 30-day social media campaign for a product or cause you care about.

Week	Deliverable
1	Buyer persona, content pillars, 30-day content calendar
2	Design 15 posts/graphics (use Canva), write all captions with hashtag research
3	Publish content, engage with audience, record baseline metrics
4	Analyse performance, write campaign report with insights

Project 3: SEO Blog — Rank for a Keyword

- Research a low-competition keyword (KD under 30, 500+ monthly searches)
- Write a 1,000-word SEO-optimised blog post targeting that keyword
- Follow the on-page SEO checklist from Chapter 4
- Submit to Google Search Console and request indexing
- Track ranking every week for the rest of the internship

Project 4: Full Digital Marketing Strategy (Capstone)

Create a comprehensive 90-day digital marketing strategy for a business of your choice (real or fictional). Present it as a 20-slide deck covering:

Section	Slides	Content
Executive Summary	1	Business overview, goal, budget
Market Analysis	2	Target audience, competitor analysis
Buyer Personas	1	2-3 detailed personas

Channel Strategy	3	Which channels and why; each platform's role
Content Plan	2	Content pillars, formats, calendar overview
SEO Strategy	2	Target keywords, on-page plan
Paid Media Plan	2	Google Ads + social ads, budgets
Email Strategy	1	Sequence plan
Analytics Setup	2	KPIs, tools, reporting cadence
Timeline & Budget	1	90-day Gantt chart, budget breakdown
Expected ROI	2	Projected metrics, assumptions, risks

Learning Resources

Google Digital Garage (Free Certification)

https://learndigital.withgoogle.com/digitalgarage

HubSpot Academy (Free Certifications)

https://academy.hubspot.com

Meta Blueprint (Facebook/Instagram Ads)

https://www.facebook.com/business/learn

Google Skillshop (Google Ads Certification)

https://skillshop.withgoogle.com

Semrush Academy

https://www.semrush.com/academy/

Neil Patel Blog

https://neilpatel.com/blog/

Backlinko Blog (SEO)

https://backlinko.com/blog

Glossary

A/B Testing — Comparing two versions to find which performs better. *Example: Email subject lines: Open rate 22% vs 18%*

Algorithm — Rules a platform uses to decide what content to show. *Example: Instagram Reels algorithm boosts new videos*

Backlink — A link from another website to yours. *Example: Forbes.com linking to your article*

Bounce Rate — % of visitors who leave after one page. *Example: High bounce = poor content match*

Buyer Persona — Fictional profile of ideal customer. *Example: Priya, 24, college student, Instagram user*

CTA — Call-to-Action — instruction to take next step. *Example: Buy Now, Sign Up, Learn More*

Conversion — Visitor completing a desired action. *Example: Filling a form, making a purchase*

CTR — Click-Through Rate = clicks / impressions x 100. *Example: CTR of 3% is good for search ads*

Content Pillar — Core topic brand consistently creates content about. *Example: Fitness brand: Workouts, Nutrition, Motivation*

CPC — Cost Per Click in paid advertising. *Example: Rs. 15 CPC on Google Ads for 'digital marketing'*

Email Deliverability — % of emails reaching the inbox, not spam. *Example: Use double opt-in to improve it*

Engagement Rate — (Likes+Comments+Shares) / Followers x 100. *Example: 3-6% is considered good on Instagram*

Funnel — Customer journey from awareness to purchase. *Example: TOFU, MOFU, BOFU stages*

Hashtag — Keyword preceded by # for social discoverability. *Example: #DigitalMarketing #SEO*

Impression — Each time content is displayed. *Example: 1,000 impressions = shown 1,000 times*

Keyword — Word/phrase people search for. *Example: 'best digital marketing course India'*

Landing Page — Dedicated page for a specific campaign or ad. *Example: Different from the homepage*

Lead Magnet — Free resource offered in exchange for email. *Example: Free checklist, ebook, webinar*

LTV — Lifetime Value of a customer. *Example: Rs. 500/month x 12 months = Rs. 6,000 LTV*

Organic Reach — Audience reached without paid promotion. *Example: Followers seeing your posts for free*

Paid Reach — Audience reached through advertising. *Example: Boosted posts, Google Ads*

ROAS — Return on Ad Spend = Revenue / Ad Spend. *Example: ROAS of 5 = Rs. 5 returned per Rs. 1 spent*

Reach — Total unique accounts that saw your content. *Example: 10,000 reach means 10,000 unique people*

Retargeting — Showing ads to people who already visited your site. *Example: Shoe store ad to someone who viewed shoes*

ROI — Return on Investment. *Example: (Profit - Cost) / Cost x 100*

SEO — Search Engine Optimisation — improving organic search ranking. *Example: Ranking #1 on Google without paying*

Segmentation — Dividing audience into groups for targeted messaging. *Example: Email list split by location/interest*

Social Proof — Evidence others trust your brand. *Example: Reviews, testimonials, follower count*

UTM Parameters — Tracking codes added to URLs. *Example: ?utm_source=instagram&utm_campaign=sale*